

CDN Incident Alert: 0051. TLP: CLEAR**Date****Title** DE R-FBI spreading article claiming German Greens committing election fraud 27/02/2025**Summary**

- Between the 21st and the 23rd of February, an R-FBI article and video claiming that the German Greens are planning election fraud was spread by mostly accounts previously observed spreading R-FBI content.
- The campaign was trying to spread the notion that the Greens will commit election fraud.
- The impact was limited, only reaching 47600 users and achieving 1,174 interactions
- The operation used a fabricated human rights NGO to produce localised content which was spread by influencers.
- The EU should enact sanctions against R-FBI.

Incident

On the 21st of February, the Russian state-aligned Foundation to Battle Injustice (R-FBI) published a German-language article and video claiming that the German Greens are planning election fraud (1). The video showed the pro-Kremlin activist Nina Popova who used to be active in the CDU party in Germany, but now lives in Russia and support the supports the organisation “Moya Rossiya” (“My Russia”) (2) One can clearly see that Popova is reading off a script.

The same day, the article was republished in English on the website vtforeignpolicy[.]com allegedly by Lucas Leiroz (3). Leiroz is a columnist at InfoBRICS (alleged GRU connection 4), CGTN (Chinese state-controlled media), and Global Research (alleged Russian proxy 5). Leiroz has been mentioned by the Clemson University as someone who spread Storm-1516 content during the U.S. elections (6). On the same day, the VT article was shared by the Twitter user @fopminui (7), an account that has previously amplified R-FBI content (E.g. 8, 9). On the next day, the German-language article was republished on the website pravda-tv[.]com (10), that is run a conspiracy athon Nikolas Pravda The link to the Pravd-TV article was shared on X by the account @Billboardtruckthat has previously shared content by R-FBI and Storm-1516.

Between the 22nd and 23rd of February, 2 screenshots and three links of the Pravda-TV article were shared to the Facebook groups “wirwerdennurnochverarscht”, “System Rebellen Reloaded”, and “Es reicht ! Wir werden nur noch verarscht” by the Facebook user Wi Re (11, 12, 13, 14, 15). The user is seemingly regularly posting screenshots of RT DE articles to these Facebook groups (e.g. 16, 17, 18). On the 23rd, an excerpt of the article and a link to the original article was shared by the Telegram channel @technikus_news (19). On the 23rd, the original article was also shared by Alina Lipp’s Telegram channel (20).

Narrative

Meta narrative: The Greens will commit election fraud.

Sub-narratives: The greens will bribe election workers; Manipulating postal voting; Disinformation campaigns.

Impact

Reach: 47,600 views and 1,174 interactions. The reach was seemingly limited to Pro-Russian spaces.

Outcome: None of relevance.

Key Objectives and Behaviours (DISARM Red Framework)

Objective: [Smear](#) – The operation is trying to smear the German Greens and discredit the election results.

- [Fabricated NGO Persona](#) – R-FBI is claiming to be a human rights NGO.
- [Create Localised Content](#) – the article is produced in German and is adapted to the German context.
- [Recruit Partisans](#) – the operation recruited ideologically-aligned Nina Popova.
- [Bait Influencer](#) – The operation relies on influencers such as Alina Lipp to amplify their content.

Recommendations and Actions Taken

Action taken: Flagged the cases to German Government agencies and social media platforms.

Recommendations: The European Union should enact sanctions against R-FBI.

Report Topic	Evidence	Authors	Platforms	Logo
N/A German Elections,	In text.	Julia Smirnova,	Facebook,	X,

Election Fraud.

CeMAS. Karolin
Schwarz, Independent.
Saman Nazari,
Alliance4Europe

Telegram